Chapter 5
Mahatma in India

Gandhi had lived away from India for more than twenty years. But his work in South Africa was well-known in India. He had written pamphlets that had been distributed there. Newspapers, in both England and India, had reported stories of his work in South Africa. His home country greeted him like a hero. Rabindranath Tagore, a famous poet of the time, called Gandhi *Mahatma* , which means “Great Soul.” Indians started calling him Mahatma to show their great respect for him.



Gandhi came home with a mission. He wanted India to govern itself. He wanted to show the British Raj that Indians would be loyal to them. He urged Indians to be confident and act fairly. He urged them to show respect to the British and not treat them as an enemy. In return, he hoped the government would give India its independence. Gandhi also wanted Indians